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AI Is Taking Over: Preparing Filipino Workers for an AI-Driven Future

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I. Introduction

Artificial intelligence (AI) is becoming increasingly common in workplaces, education, business, and everyday activities. As a matter of fact, I used AI in polishing this paper out of pressure and frustration over the mountain of tasks I have to do for my professional courses. I could go on and on ranting about this setup, but we can never deny that AI can perform tasks that traditionally require human effort, effortlessly. It's true that AI can improve productivity and create opportunities, however, it comes with a cost. In this paper, I will focus more on work-related *colonization*.

My research shows that approximately, 12.7 million Filipino workers are exposed to generative AI. This suggests that some tasks in their occupations can potentially be affected or changed by AI (ILO, 2026). Moreover, the increase in usage changes what employers expect from workers. In fact, 70% of Filipino business leaders said they would only hire someone with AI skills. Saddening, but this reveals that AI knowledge is slowly becoming an important part of employability. Workers who do not have opportunities to develop new digital and AI-related skills may face difficulty adapting to changing workplace requirements. Hence, the problem is not simply that AI will take over, the burden is widened to workers having to continuously adapt.

This proposal aims to discuss the problems caused by the rapid adoption of AI and propose practical solutions that can help Filipino workers prepare for an AI-driven workplace. Through AI education, reskilling, and responsible human-AI collaboration, workers can learn to use AI as a tool rather than view it only as a threat to employment.

II. Problem Description

If I am being honest, the first problem I see with AI in the workplace is the AI readiness gap. We are being told to adapt, upskill, and “learn AI” as if everyone has the same time, resources, and opportunities to do so. But workers already have their own responsibilities, deadlines, and workloads. Now, on top of those, they are expected to

keep up with technology that changes almost as quickly as it is introduced. The ILO (2025) emphasizes the importance of developing skills that allow workers to adapt to the changes brought by artificial intelligence. The problem, however, is that not everyone gets the same chance to develop these skills.

Another concern is job displacement and job transformation. AI can perform repetitive and predictable tasks that were once handled by people. While it may not completely erase an entire occupation, it can change what workers are expected to do. The ILO (2026) explains that generative AI is more likely to transform many jobs than completely replace them. Personally, I find this almost more concerning because it means that keeping a job may no longer mean simply being good at that job. Workers may also have to prove that they can work alongside AI, understand it, and adapt whenever their responsibilities change. In other words, AI does not necessarily have to take your job away to make you feel that you have to constantly compete with it.

This issue also concerns students like me who are preparing to enter the workforce. We are not only studying to understand our professions anymore. We are also trying to figure out how AI will fit into the jobs we have not even started yet. There is a certain irony in being told to prepare for the future while the future keeps changing before we can even catch up. Without proper AI education and accessible training, students and workers may end up learning AI only because they are afraid of being left behind.

III. Proposed Solution

“AI-AI, may trabaho pa?” Sounds like a joke, but honestly, it is a question that is becoming harder to laugh off. If AI can write, analyze, organize, create, and even perform tasks that used to require human effort, then naturally, the next question is: where does that leave us? Instead of simply telling Filipino workers to be afraid of AI or, worse, telling them to “just learn AI,” I propose AI-RCA (AI Readiness and Career Adaptation System)—a digital platform designed to help Filipino students, job seekers,

and workers understand how AI may affect their work and, more importantly, what they can do about it. *The acronym actually sucks but my brain is half-fried from case presentations, and I really hope this idea sells.*

AI-RCA would have three main features: an AI Exposure Check that identifies which work tasks may be affected by AI, a Skills Gap Tracker that recommends skills users need to develop, and an AI Practice Hub where users can safely practice using AI for work or school. The system would also provide accessible learning resources, short courses, and micro-credentials while reminding users to verify AI-generated information, protect personal data, and maintain human judgment.

The goal of AI-RCA is not to stop AI from entering the workplace because, realistically, that ship has already sailed. Instead, it aims to help Filipino workers become prepared rather than afraid. By combining AI education, reskilling, and responsible AI use, the system can help workers adapt to changing job requirements and use AI as a tool rather than simply seeing it as competition. So, to answer the question, “AI-AI, may trabaho pa?” — *meron, basta handa tayo.*

IV. Conclusion

AI is not going away, and honestly, neither are the workers who are trying to keep up with it. The problem is not simply that AI can take over certain tasks, but that Filipino workers and students are being pressured to adapt to a rapidly changing workplace, sometimes without enough resources or preparation. Through **AI-RCA**, I propose a practical way to turn that pressure into preparation by helping users identify how AI may affect their work, recognize the skills they need, and learn how to use AI responsibly. At the end of the day, we do not need to beat AI at being AI—we just need to make sure that people remain capable, prepared, and relevant alongside it. So, *AI-AI, may trabaho pa? Meron. Basta handa tayo.*

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